

including Los Angeles, London, and Monaco. But all look extremely bland with no hint of life anywhere. Even on a GeForce2 with a 900 MHz Duron, the frame rate stuttered and popped at the lowest resolutions. The cars are over-reflective and the textures flat and lifeless. The graphics engine is four years too old.

The game's great in concept, but not in implementation. Bad controls, poor graphics, pedestrian sound effects, no multiplayer, a console of a menu system and unchallenging gameplay. Almost every racing game ends with some techno or trance music and this one is no different. If you

like trance, *Supercar* has one of the best soundtracks around. It features Captain Tinrib, DJ Micro and Keoki along with a host of other performers from Moonshine Records.

Simply put, this game fares poorly and cannot hold a candle to the likes of *Need for Speed*, *Colin Mc Rae*, or *4x4*

*Evolution*. Even the extra effort on packaging—the snazzy DVD case, free demo CD, and a poster fail to impress against this onslaught of awfulness.

**Developer:** Exakt Entertainment  
**Genre:** Racing  
**Contact:** Milestone Interactive  
**Phone:** 022-8381614  
**Price:** Rs 699  
**Rating:** ★★

## DESIGNING VISUAL BASIC .NET APPLICATIONS

### A RAD book, this!

Visual Basic has been the most popular Rapid Application Development (RAD) tool ever. Now that .NET is coming up as a services platform, Visual Basic for .NET is so hot that you definitely need to get your basics right. This book gives you a refresher course on what .NET is all about and how you can use Visual Basic.NET to develop applications for the platform. You will get a sneak preview of the changes that have been implemented into the language core. Explanations on accessibility to databases using the ADO.NET are so lucid that even a novice should find it easy. For those of you unfamiliar with XML



or SOAP, this book gives comprehensive explanations on working with the same. In all this is a project management book. It helps you learn, plan, develop, and deploy .NET applications in a jiffy.

The flipside, however, is that you should already be a software architect, or at least an expert at Visual Basic to understand the real essence of developing applications for this platform.

**Publisher:** IDG Books India Pvt Ltd  
**Contact:** IDG Books India Pvt Ltd  
**Phone:** 91-011-3275895  
**E-mail:** idgbooks@vsnl.com  
**Price:** Rs 249  
**Rating:** ★★★

Web services such as setting up an Apache server, running an FTP server, building new kernels, and maintaining system security.

Although it doesn't claim to be a 'bible', it's a pretty good book to start out with. To put things in a nutshell, this book can help you skim the surface of working with Linux and you will learn the

ropes to some extent, but 'mastering' Linux would take you a lot more study and effort.

**Publisher:** IDG Books India Pvt Ltd  
**Contact:** IDG Books India Pvt Ltd  
**Phone:** 91-011-3275895  
**E-mail:** idgbooks@vsnl.com  
**Price:** Rs 169  
**Rating:** ★★★

## WINDOWS XP PLAIN AND SIMPLE

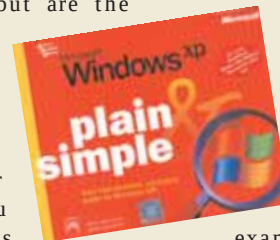
### Quick and easy

Windows XP is the best operating system from Microsoft yet and everyone wants to use it. If you share the sentiment but are the kind who doesn't take too kindly to figuring out the various features of your OS on your own, then you can turn to this book for the simplest of guidance. Another reason is that you won't have to browse through pages of dense text. You will find just the required amount of information. You can learn to fix all your XP related problems using the concise instructions in this book. The book is packed with images and illustrations that help you further your understanding of Windows XP. Starting with a mention of the new features of the OS, to its networking and other interesting capabilities,

the book deals with the essentials of XP in an interesting manner. For those of you working for the first time with networks, setting up network connections with Windows XP will be quite difficult. But with the guidance and examples offered here,

you too can cure your networking hangups in Windows XP. A must have for every Windows XP home user, this book is like a product manual that you can refer to when you have a problem with your new fancy OS.

**Publisher:** Prentice Hall of India Pvt Ltd  
**Contact:** Computer BookShop  
**Phone:** 022-2070989, 2076356  
**E-mail:** cbsbom@giasbm01.vsnl.net.in  
**Price:** Rs 225  
**Rating:** ★★★★



## RED HAT LINUX 7.X IN 2 1/2 DAYS

### Learn the ropes, yet to walk it

Learning Red Hat Linux 7.x in two-and-a-half days is quite a feat for anyone to achieve. While the goal of this book may seem a little too far fetched, the book is still pretty well written and good enough to help a novice reach



the intermediate level.

The book opens with a guide to the very initial steps such as installing the software, as well as troubleshooting the installation if you happen to face any glitches at the very onset. Next on the menu is exploring various tasks such as using the shell, bash commands, networking, Internet, etc. It also deals with complex topics such as setting up Internet services such as e-mail and